

Nick Kostalas

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Instructional Designer and Technical Writer/Editor

Technical instructional designer with a successful track record in developing engaging and effective technical eLearning curricula across multiple mediums—including web-based and instructor-led training—that drive performance, improve operational efficiency, and deliver results.

Collaborative and trusted leader with expertise in fostering key relationships across all levels of an organization, maintaining open and effective communication, supporting large-scale change initiatives, and optimizing the use of available resources to achieve all deliverable goals and strategic objectives.

Critical thinker and motivated problem solver who sees every challenge as an opportunity to find a creative solution. Adept at rapidly downloading technical information and distilling it into efficient learning material for novice and expert audiences alike. Constantly improving processes and outcomes.

Expertise

Industry acumen: Learning experience design | Instructional design | Curriculum development | Technical enablement | Technical writing | Editing | Publishing | Content creation | Content management | User experience design (UI/UX) | Design thinking | Interaction design | Storytelling | eLearning | Adult learning theory | ADDIE and SAM | Brand management | Data analysis | Working knowledge of AI/LLM applications in learning design

Leadership: Stakeholder engagement | Relationship management | Executive relations | Coaching | Mentoring | Training | Facilitation | Presentation | Strategic project planning

Technical: Articulate Storyline and Rise | MadCap Flare | Adobe Photoshop and Illustrator | Atlassian Jira and Confluence | Schoox LMS | HTML | XML | CSS | SQL | Google Workspace | Microsoft 365 | PowerPoint | Excel | Word | Dassault Systèmes 3DEXPERIENCE (3DX) | CATIA Composer

Experience

Production Editor, Technical Publications | Rivian Automotive 2024 – 2025

Published user-facing technical documentation to vehicle software and [Rivian.com](#), working with technical writers and software engineers to carefully usher projects through multiple stages of production, ensuring quality, accuracy, and consistency at every step.

- **Quality assurance**—Performed comprehensive reviews on 2,000+ pages of vehicle owner's guide material every four weeks, comparing against change log and ensuring accuracy, completeness, and adherence to style guide
- **Process improvement**—Identified a critical flaw in the publishing process and secured approval from leadership to add failsafe steps, improve documentation, and implement automation—resulting in improvements to data security, product quality, and efficiency
- **Knowledge management**—Led an improvement initiative to update and validate process documentation across the department, including revising internal help guides based on current best practices
- **Structured authoring**—Edited XML files in MadCap Flare for content, style, and formatting

Interactive Media and Instructional Designer, Technical Training | Lucid Motors

2022 – 2024

Collaborated with cross-functional teams—including 20+ engineers, technicians, and subject matter experts—to perform needs analysis, deeply understand the material and audience, create useful technical resources, and develop and administer application-oriented technical training programs.

- **Project management**—Successfully delivered 20+ projects on time by communicating with stakeholders and strategizing roadmaps that outlined priorities, timelines, and quality standards
- **Technical curriculum development**—Authored 12+ hours of SCORM-based training courses on safety-critical subjects including vehicle systems design, theory of operation, and hands-on repair procedures, supporting a global team of 150+ electric vehicle service technicians
- **Interactive learning design**—Designed and built 60+ slides of sophisticated and user-friendly interactive multimedia activities, crafting an engaging user experience and enabling students to develop proficiency through exploration and practice
- **LMS administration**—Administered Schoox learning management system (LMS) for 200+ users: managed course library, provided responsive learning support and troubleshooting, and created detailed software walkthroughs in Tango
- **Data-driven improvement**—Collected, analyzed, and acted on user performance data for 20+ courses: measured course effectiveness, provided recommendations to leadership, and implemented content and functionality improvements, resulting in a 20% increase in first-attempt pass rates
- **AI tool evaluation**—Evaluated adoption of Synthesia AI voice-over tool in the technical training video pipeline, assessing output quality, consistency, and fit for safety-critical technical content

Instructional Designer and Technical Writer | Freelance

2019 – 2022

Consulted with executives to deeply understand organizational objectives and resources. Leveraged insights and expertise to create business plans, training content, and technical documentation.

- **Curriculum strategy**—Consulted with a startup to study the competitive environment in online driver education, analyze regulatory requirements in 10+ U.S. states, map out a curriculum and course library, and plan an innovative single-source approach to content development
- **Technical editing**—Edited, validated, and localized 200+ pages of technical documentation for accuracy, consistency, and alignment with style guide
- Key clients include **Aceable, Inc.** (U.S.) and **SB Works Co.** (Japan)

Curriculum Developer, Driver Education | eDriving

2011 – 2019

Developed 20+ online training courses and an innovative video-based microlearning app ([Mentor](#)) on subjects including vehicle operation procedures, highway safety design, and safe driving best practices.

- **Interactive multimedia design**—Worked independently and collaborated with designers to produce 200+ instructional graphics, games, interactive 3D simulations, worksheets, audio scripts, and storyboards for original video
- **Continuous improvement**—Took initiative to develop standard procedures for collecting, analyzing, and acting on user feedback, increasing student pass rates with targeted changes to content and assessments

Education

Bachelor of Arts in Rhetoric | University of California, Berkeley